



Figure 1: Welcome screen



Figure 2: Virtual Hard Disk screen

## Setting up a new VM

Type *virtualbox* in a terminal window, or launch it from *Applications>Accessories>VirtualBox OSE*. Figure 1 illustrates the welcome screen/main window—I've already created some VMs in my installation, so the list isn't empty; and the right pane shows information for the selected VM.

To begin creating a new VM, click the **New** toolbar button. Read through the subsequently displayed window, and click **Next**. In the next dialogue box, enter a name for the VM, and select the *OS Type*. I'm installing Fedora, so I chose 'Linux', and in the *Version* drop-down, 'Fedora'. Next, you must allocate the base memory size (RAM allocated to the VM). It is recommended to allocate less than 50 per cent of your physical RAM, but this can be varied. Click **Next** to proceed to the *Virtual Hard Disk* screen (shown in Figure 2).

A virtual hard disk, also called a Virtual Disk Image or VDI, is a file (in your host OS) that is presented as a hard disk to the guest OS 'inside' the VM. In most cases, you will create a new VDI, unless you are re-using an existing one, or booting up a 'virtual appliance' VDI that you've downloaded, for example. Since we're installing from scratch, create a new VDI, allocating sufficient

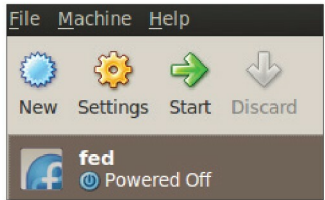


Figure 3: VirtualBox window with new VM



Figure 4: Select Installation Media dialogue

hard disk space for all you want to do in the virtual machine (for example, to install various software from repositories). After you click the *Finish* button, you are returned to the main VirtualBox window, where your new VM is listed. The **Start** toolbar button is now enabled, as shown in Figure 3.



**Note:** If you choose a dynamic VDI, the space on your host filesystem will begin getting used up as you store data in the VM.

## Starting the new VM

Select the new VM, and click the **Start** button. You will see the first *Run wizard* window. Click **Next** and you will see the *Select Installation Media* dialogue box, as shown in Figure 4. If you have a physical CD/DVD disk, insert it in your drive, and choose the CD/DVD drive in the *Media Source* drop-down menu. To install from an ISO image, click the **Browse** button next to the drop-down menu, navigate to, and choose your ISO image file. Click **Next**, and then **Finish**. Follow the usual installation procedure for the guest OS, just as you would with a blank hard disk on a physical system.